

VOCABULARY · CULTURE · ACTIVITIES

SPANISH SPEAKING COUNTRIES

El mundo hispano

Twenty-one places where Spanish is spoken every day, with Spain 🇪🇸 and Argentina 🇦🇷 vocabulary

PONCHO
SPANISH

¡HOLA!

Spanish is not one country's language. It is spoken on both sides of the Atlantic, in the mountains, by the sea, in enormous cities and in tiny villages, and it sounds a little different in every one of them.

This resource takes you round the Spanish-speaking world: the countries and their capitals, the landscapes, the food, the music, and the words that change as you travel. More than 80 words and expressions, each one in a real sentence.

You don't need to know any of it already. Read a little at a time, say the names out loud, and look for the countries on a map as you go. At the end there are activities to check what you remember, and all the answers.

How to use it

1. **Find each country on a map.** Words stick far better when they have a place.
2. **Say the names out loud.** Nicaragua, Paraguay, Honduras: they're fun to say.
3. **Notice the differences.** The same thing can have three names in three countries.
4. **Try the activities** without looking back, then check the answers.

One language, many voices

Spanish is the official language of twenty countries, plus Puerto Rico. Nobody speaks "neutral" Spanish: everyone has an accent, and all of them are correct.

el autobús 🇪🇸 = **el colectivo** 🇦🇷

¿Español o castellano?

Both words mean the same language. In Spain and in much of South America people often say **castellano**; in Mexico, Central America and in English we usually say **español**. Use whichever you like.

el español = **el castellano**

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CONTENIDO

01 LOS PAÍSES — THE COUNTRIES

02 CAPITALES Y BANDERAS — CAPITALS AND FLAGS

03 PAISAJES Y LUGARES — LANDSCAPES AND PLACES

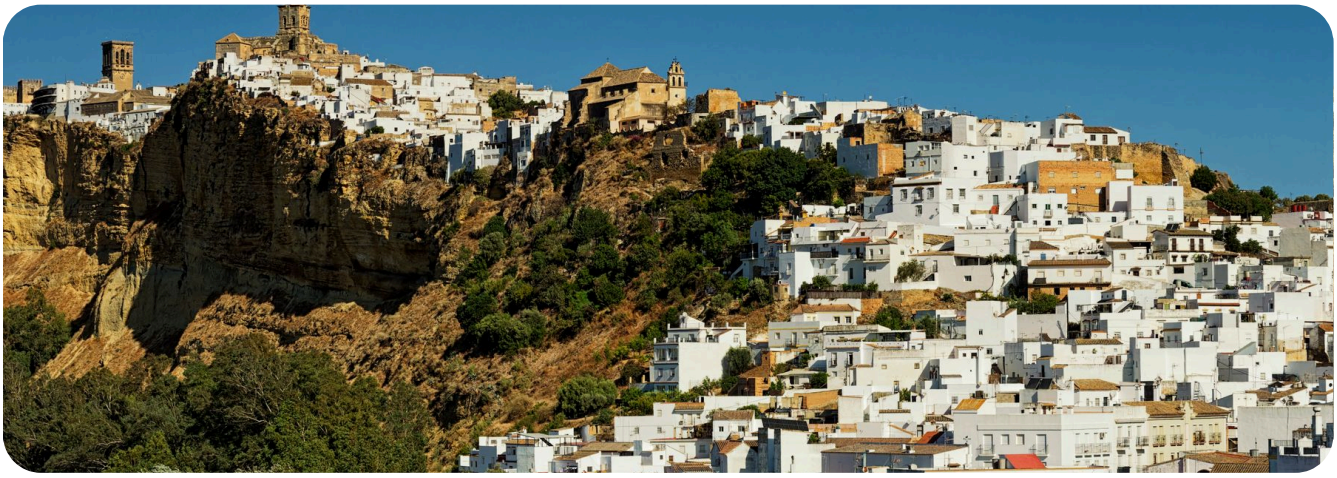
04 LA COMIDA DE CADA PAÍS — FOOD COUNTRY BY COUNTRY

05 LA MISMA COSA, OTRA PALABRA — SAME THING, DIFFERENT WORD

06 FIESTAS, MÚSICA Y BAILE — FESTIVALS, MUSIC AND DANCE

07 FRASES DEL MUNDO HISPANO — PHRASES FOR TRAVELLING THE MAP

08 ¡A PRACTICAR! — ACTIVITIES & ANSWERS



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01

LOS PAÍSES

THE COUNTRIES

Twenty countries, one language. Say each name out loud as you read it.

ESPAÑOL	ENGLISH	EN UNA FRASE
el país	the country	*¿En qué país se habla español?* In which country is Spanish spoken?
España	Spain	*España está en el sur de Europa.* Spain is in the south of Europe.
México	Mexico	*México es el país con más hispanohablantes.* Mexico is the country with the most Spanish speakers.
Argentina	Argentina	*Argentina es muy larga y muy estrecha.* Argentina is very long and very narrow.
Colombia	Colombia	*Colombia tiene costa en dos océanos.* Colombia has a coast on two oceans.
Perú	Peru	*En Perú está Machu Picchu.* Machu Picchu is in Peru.
Chile	Chile	*Chile mide más de cuatro mil kilómetros.* Chile is more than four thousand kilometres long.
Guatemala	Guatemala	*Guatemala tiene muchos volcanes.* Guatemala has lots of volcanoes.
Cuba	Cuba	*Cuba es una isla del Caribe.* Cuba is an island in the Caribbean.
Bolivia	Bolivia	*Bolivia no tiene salida al mar.* Bolivia has no coastline.

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01 · LOS PAÍSES THE COUNTRIES

ESPAÑOL	ENGLISH	EN UNA FRASE
Uruguay	Uruguay	*Uruguay es el país más pequeño del sur.* Uruguay is the smallest country in the south.
Costa Rica	Costa Rica	*Costa Rica protege sus bosques.* Costa Rica protects its forests.
Guinea Ecuatorial	Equatorial Guinea	*Guinea Ecuatorial está en África.* Equatorial Guinea is in Africa.
Puerto Rico	Puerto Rico	*En Puerto Rico se habla español e inglés.* In Puerto Rico people speak Spanish and English.

¿SABÍAS QUE...?

Spanish is the official language of twenty countries: Spain, Mexico, Guatemala, Honduras, El Salvador, Nicaragua, Costa Rica, Panama, Cuba, the Dominican Republic, Colombia, Venezuela, Ecuador, Peru, Bolivia, Chile, Paraguay, Uruguay, Argentina and Equatorial Guinea. Puerto Rico makes twenty-one places, and it is a territory of the United States rather than a country.

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02

CAPITALES Y BANDERAS

CAPITALS AND FLAGS

Every country has a capital city, a flag and a word for its people.

ESPAÑOL	ENGLISH	EN UNA FRASE
la capital	the capital city	*La capital de Perú es Lima.* The capital of Peru is Lima.
Madrid	Madrid	*Madrid está en el centro de España.* Madrid is in the centre of Spain.
Ciudad de México	Mexico City	*Ciudad de México es enorme.* Mexico City is enormous.
Buenos Aires	Buenos Aires	*Buenos Aires está junto a un río muy ancho.* Buenos Aires sits beside a very wide river.
Bogotá	Bogotá	*Bogotá está a 2.600 metros de altura.* Bogotá is 2,600 metres above sea level.
La Habana	Havana	*Los coches antiguos de La Habana son famosos.* The old cars of Havana are famous.
la bandera	the flag	*La bandera de Argentina es celeste y blanca.* The flag of Argentina is light blue and white.
la estrella	the star	*La bandera de Chile tiene una estrella.* The flag of Chile has one star.
el sol	the sun	*El sol de la bandera uruguaya tiene cara.* The sun on the Uruguayan flag has a face.
la franja	the stripe	*Muchas banderas tienen tres franjas.* Lots of flags have three stripes.

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02 · CAPITALES Y BANDERAS CAPITALS AND FLAGS

ESPAÑOL	ENGLISH	EN UNA FRASE
español / española	Spanish (person)	*Mi profesora es española.* My teacher is Spanish.
mexicano / mexicana	Mexican	*Frida Kahlo era mexicana.* Frida Kahlo was Mexican.
argentino / argentina	Argentinian	*Mi amigo argentino vive en Córdoba.* My Argentinian friend lives in Córdoba.
hispanohablante	Spanish-speaking	*Hay países hispanohablantes en tres continentes.* There are Spanish-speaking countries on three continents.

¿Sabías que...?

Bolivia has two capitals: Sucre is the constitutional capital, where the supreme court sits, and La Paz is where the government and the president work. La Paz is one of the highest capital cities in the world.

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03

PAISAJES Y LUGARES

LANDSCAPES AND PLACES

Deserts, jungles, glaciers and beaches, sometimes all in the same country.

ESPAÑOL	ENGLISH	EN UNA FRASE
el paisaje	the landscape	*El paisaje cambia cada cien kilómetros.* The landscape changes every hundred kilometres.
la montaña	the mountain	*Los Andes son las montañas más largas del mundo.* The Andes are the longest mountains in the world.
la cordillera	the mountain range	*La cordillera cruza siete países.* The mountain range crosses seven countries.
el volcán	the volcano	*En Guatemala hay volcanes activos.* There are active volcanoes in Guatemala.
la selva	the rainforest	*La selva amazónica es gigante.* The Amazon rainforest is gigantic.
el desierto	the desert	*El desierto de Atacama casi nunca ve lluvia.* The Atacama desert almost never sees rain.
el glaciar	the glacier	*El glaciar hace un ruido enorme al romperse.* The glacier makes an enormous noise as it breaks.
la playa	the beach	*Las playas del Caribe son blancas.* The beaches of the Caribbean are white.
la isla	the island	*Cuba y Puerto Rico son islas.* Cuba and Puerto Rico are islands.
el río	the river	*El río Amazonas pasa por Perú y Colombia.* The Amazon river runs through Peru and Colombia.

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03 · PAISAJES Y LUGARES LANDSCAPES AND PLACES

ESPAÑOL	ENGLISH	EN UNA FRASE
el lago	the lake	*El lago Titicaca está entre Perú y Bolivia.* Lake Titicaca lies between Peru and Bolivia.
la pampa	the plains	*En la pampa hay vacas y caballos.* There are cows and horses on the plains.
la costa	the coast	*Vivimos cerca de la costa.* We live near the coast.
el pueblo blanco	the whitewashed village	*Los pueblos blancos están en el sur de España.* The whitewashed villages are in the south of Spain.

¿Sabías que...?

The Atacama desert in Chile is the driest place on Earth outside the poles: there are weather stations there that have never recorded a drop of rain. Its skies are so clear that some of the world's biggest telescopes are built on its hills.

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04

LA COMIDA DE CADA PAÍS

FOOD COUNTRY BY COUNTRY

One language, and a completely different plate in every kitchen.

ESPAÑOL	ENGLISH	EN UNA FRASE
la comida	the food	*La comida cambia mucho de un país a otro.* Food changes a lot from one country to another.
la paella	paella	*La paella es de Valencia, en España.* Paella comes from Valencia, in Spain.
el taco	the taco	*En México el taco se come con la mano.* In Mexico a taco is eaten with your hand.
la empanada	the pasty, the empanada	*Cada provincia hace su empanada.* Every province makes its own empanada.
el asado	the barbecue	*El asado del domingo es una tradición.* Sunday barbecue is a tradition.
la arepa	the arepa (maize bread)	*La arepa es de Venezuela y Colombia.* The arepa comes from Venezuela and Colombia.
el ceviche	ceviche (marinated fish)	*El ceviche peruano lleva limón.* Peruvian ceviche has lime in it.
el mole	mole (chilli and chocolate sauce)	*El mole lleva muchísimos ingredientes.* Mole has an enormous number of ingredients.
el gallo pinto	rice and beans	*En Costa Rica se desayuna gallo pinto.* In Costa Rica people have rice and beans for breakfast.
las pupusas	pupusas (stuffed flatbreads)	*Las pupusas son de El Salvador.* Pupusas come from El Salvador.

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04 · LA COMIDA DE CADA PAÍS FOOD COUNTRY BY COUNTRY

ESPAÑOL	ENGLISH	EN UNA FRASE
el dulce de leche	caramel milk spread	*El dulce de leche va en todo.* Caramel milk spread goes in everything.
el mate	mate (herbal tea)	*El mate se comparte entre amigos.* Mate is shared between friends.
el chocolate	chocolate	*El chocolate viene de América.* Chocolate comes from the Americas.
el maíz	maize, sweetcorn	*El maíz está en casi todas las cocinas.* Maize is in almost every kitchen.

¿SABÍAS QUE...?

Chocolate, tomatoes, potatoes, maize, peanuts, chillies and vanilla all came from the Americas. Before 1500 there were no tomatoes in Italy and no potatoes in Ireland: the food of half the world changed because of these plants.

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05

LA MISMA COSA, OTRA PALABRA

SAME THING, DIFFERENT WORD

The word you learn in Spain may make people smile in Argentina, and the other way round.

ESPAÑOL	ENGLISH	EN UNA FRASE
el autobús 🇪🇸 el colectivo 🇦🇷	the bus	*Voy al centro en autobús.* I go into town by bus.
el coche 🇪🇸 el auto 🇦🇷	the car	*El coche de mi padre es viejo.* My dad's car is old.
el móvil 🇪🇸 el celular 🇦🇷	the mobile phone	*Mi móvil no tiene batería.* My phone has no battery.
el ordenador 🇪🇸 la computadora 🇦🇷	the computer	*El ordenador del cole es lento.* The school computer is slow.
el zumo 🇪🇸 el jugo 🇦🇷	the juice	*Un zumo de naranja, por favor.* An orange juice, please.
la patata 🇪🇸 la papa 🇦🇷	the potato	*Me encantan las patatas fritas.* I love chips.
el bolígrafo 🇪🇸 la lapicera 🇦🇷	the pen	*¿Me prestas un bolígrafo?* Can you lend me a pen?
la piscina 🇪🇸 la pileta 🇦🇷	the swimming pool	*En verano vamos a la piscina.* In summer we go to the pool.
conducir 🇪🇸 manejar 🇦🇷	to drive	*Mi madre conduce al trabajo.* My mum drives to work.
coger 🇪🇸 agarrar 🇦🇷	to take, to grab	*Voy a coger el tren.* I'm going to take the train.

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05 · LA MISMA COSA, OTRA PALABRA

SAME THING, DIFFERENT WORD

ESPAÑOL	ENGLISH	EN UNA FRASE
el camarero 🇪🇸 el mozo 🇦🇷	the waiter	*El camarero trae la cuenta.* The waiter brings the bill.
bonito 🇪🇸 lindo 🇦🇷	lovely, pretty	*¡Qué bonito es este pueblo!* What a lovely village!
guay 🇪🇸 copado 🇦🇷	cool, great	*Tu mochila es muy guay.* Your backpack is really cool.
tú 🇪🇸 vos 🇦🇷	you (to a friend)	*¿Tú de dónde eres?* Where are you from?

¿SABÍAS QUE...?

In most of Argentina, Uruguay, Paraguay and parts of Central America people say vos instead of tú, with its own verb forms: ¿vos tenés?, ¿vos querés? It is not slang. It is how millions of people speak Spanish every day.

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06

FIESTAS, MÚSICA Y BAILE

FESTIVALS, MUSIC AND DANCE

Every country has a rhythm, and most of them want you to get up and dance.

ESPAÑOL	ENGLISH	EN UNA FRASE
la fiesta	the festival, the party	*En agosto hay fiestas en todos los pueblos.* In August there are festivals in every village.
la música	the music	*La música de cada país suena distinta.* Each country's music sounds different.
el baile	the dance	*El baile empieza después de la cena.* The dancing starts after dinner.
bailar	to dance	*Aquí baila todo el mundo, hasta los abuelos.* Everyone dances here, even the grandparents.
el flamenco	flamenco	*El flamenco es del sur de España.* Flamenco comes from the south of Spain.
el tango	tango	*El tango nació en Buenos Aires y Montevideo.* Tango was born in Buenos Aires and Montevideo.
la salsa	salsa	*La salsa se baila en pareja.* Salsa is danced in pairs.
la cumbia	cumbia	*La cumbia es de la costa colombiana.* Cumbia comes from the Colombian coast.
el reguetón	reggaeton	*El reguetón salió de Puerto Rico.* Reggaeton came out of Puerto Rico.
el mariachi	mariachi band	*Los mariachis tocan trompetas y violines.* Mariachi bands play trumpets and violins.

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06 · FIESTAS, MÚSICA Y BAILE

FESTIVALS, MUSIC AND DANCE

ESPAÑOL	ENGLISH	EN UNA FRASE
la guitarra	the guitar	*Mi primo toca la guitarra.* My cousin plays the guitar.
el tambor	the drum	*Se oyen los tambores desde lejos.* You can hear the drums from far away.
el carnaval	carnival	*El carnaval dura varios días.* Carnival goes on for several days.
el desfile	the parade	*El desfile pasa por la plaza mayor.* The parade goes through the main square.

¿SABÍAS QUE...?

Tango began in the port neighbourhoods of Buenos Aires and Montevideo, where people from many countries arrived by boat and mixed their music together. UNESCO added it to its list of the intangible cultural heritage of humanity in 2009, shared between Argentina and Uruguay.

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07

FRASES DEL MUNDO HISPANO

PHRASES FOR TRAVELLING THE MAP

Short sentences you could really use. When there are two versions, the second is how you'd say it in Argentina.

¿De dónde eres?
Where are you from?

Soy de Inglaterra.
I'm from England.

¿Dónde está Guatemala?
Where is Guatemala?

Está en Centroamérica.
It's in Central America.

¿Cuál es la capital de Chile?
What's the capital of Chile?

En mi país se habla inglés.
In my country we speak English.

Me gustaría visitar Perú.
I'd like to visit Peru.

¿Cómo se dice en tu país?
How do you say it in your country?

Aquí decimos «colectivo».
Here we say 'colectivo'.

¡Qué bonito país! / ¡Qué lindo país!
What a lovely country!

¿Me enseñas en el mapa?
Can you show me on the map?

Algún día voy a ir.
One day I'm going to go.

¿SABÍAS QUE...?

Almost 500 million people speak Spanish as their first language, and it is the second most spoken mother tongue in the world after Mandarin Chinese. The country with the most Spanish speakers is Mexico, not Spain.

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08

¡A PRACTICAR!

ACTIVITIES

1 MATCH THEM UP

Write the letter of the English meaning next to each Spanish word or phrase.

1	la capital	☐	A	the flag
2	la bandera	☐	B	the island
3	el paisaje	☐	C	Spanish-speaking
4	la selva	☐	D	the capital city
5	el volcán	☐	E	to dance
6	la isla	☐	F	the volcano
7	hispanohablante	☐	G	the parade
8	el desfile	☐	H	the landscape
9	el país	☐	I	the country
10	bailar	☐	J	the rainforest

2 ¿VERDADERO O FALSO?

Read each sentence and circle V (true) or F (false).

1. El español es la lengua oficial de veinte países. **V** **F**
2. Guinea Ecuatorial está en América del Sur. **V** **F**
3. La capital de Perú es Lima. **V** **F**
4. El tango nació en México. **V** **F**
5. Cuba es una isla del Caribe. **V** **F**
6. Bolivia tiene playa en el océano Pacífico. **V** **F**

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3 UNA POSTAL DESDE QUITO

Complete Mateo's postcard with the words from the box.

país · capital · montañas · español · comida · música · mapa · volver

¡Hola! Estoy en Ecuador, un _____ pequeño y precioso. Quito, la _____, está rodeada de _____ muy altas. Aquí todo el mundo habla _____ y la gente es simpatiquísima. La _____ lleva mucho maíz y la _____ suena en la calle todo el día. Te enseño el _____ cuando vuelva. ¡Quiero _____ el año que viene!

4 SPAIN OR ARGENTINA?

Write the word used in Argentina next to the one used in Spain.

- **el autobús** → _____
- **el coche** → _____
- **el móvil** → _____
- **el zumo** → _____
- **la patata** → _____
- **la piscina** → _____
- **el camarero** → _____
- **bonito** → _____

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5 SOPA DE LETRAS

Find the 12 words. They go across → or down ↓.

V	D	R	B	G	J	E	H	N	N	R	C
E	F	P	N	T	I	E	O	T	I	O	M
S	V	N	B	O	L	I	V	I	A	H	E
P	O	C	F	E	H	H	C	H	I	L	E
A	L	A	R	U	F	I	T	A	N	G	O
N	C	C	J	A	E	O	T	M	V	M	U
A	A	U	L	E	S	V	B	P	T	A	N
N	N	B	N	N	S	E	L	V	A	D	P
D	R	A	M	E	X	I	C	O	N	R	E
B	A	N	D	E	R	A	B	G	C	I	R
G	S	A	L	S	A	P	F	D	L	D	U
V	B	D	A	U	E	T	D	M	V	A	C

ESPANA

MEXICO

CHILE

PERU

CUBA

BOLIVIA

MADRID

BANDERA

SELVA

VOLCAN

TANGO

SALSA

6 PUT IT IN ORDER

Unscramble each sentence and write it on the line.

1. ¿De / eres / dónde

_____

2. de / Santiago / La / capital / es / Chile

_____

3. visitar / Perú / Me / gustaría

_____

4. habla / se / inglés / En / mi / país

_____

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7 TU PAÍS FAVORITO

Choose one country from this resource and write four or five sentences about it: where it is, its capital, what the landscape is like, one food and one kind of music. Use at least six words from this resource.

Try: ___ está en… La capital es… Hay montañas / playas / selva… Se come… Se baila…

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ANSWERS

1 · MATCH THEM UP

1–D, 2–A, 3–H, 4–J, 5–F, 6–B, 7–C, 8–G, 9–I, 10–E

2 · ¿VERDADERO O FALSO?

1 V, 2 F, 3 V, 4 F, 5 V, 6 F

3 · UNA POSTAL DESDE QUITO

1. país, 2. capital, 3. montañas, 4. español, 5. comida, 6. música, 7. mapa, 8. volver

4 · SPAIN OR ARGENTINA?

el autobús → el colectivo; el coche → el auto; el móvil → el celular; el zumo → el jugo; la patata → la papa; la piscina → la pileta; el camarero → el mozo; bonito → lindo

6 · PUT IT IN ORDER

¿De dónde eres? · La capital de Chile es Santiago. · Me gustaría visitar Perú. · En mi país se habla inglés.

7 · TU PAÍS FAVORITO

Any answer that uses six words from this resource is perfect. Check it on a map afterwards: did you get the capital right?

5 · SOPA DE LETRAS

V	D	R	B	G	J	E	H	N	N	R	C
E	F	P	N	T	I	E	O	T	I	O	M
S	V	N	B	O	L	I	V	I	A	H	E
P	O	C	F	E	H	H	C	H	I	L	E
A	L	A	R	U	F	I	T	A	N	G	O
N	C	C	J	A	E	O	T	M	V	M	U
A	A	U	L	E	S	V	B	P	T	A	N
N	N	B	N	N	S	E	L	V	A	D	P
D	R	A	M	E	X	I	C	O	N	R	E
B	A	N	D	E	R	A	B	G	C	I	R
G	S	A	L	S	A	P	F	D	L	D	U
V	B	D	A	U	E	T	D	M	V	A	C

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¡BUEN VIAJE!

SEE YOU SOON

Twenty-one places, one language and almost 500 million people to talk to. You don't have to get on a plane to start: put on some cumbia, cook something new, and say the names of the countries out loud.

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SPANISH

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